25901247 **Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam**

MGU-UGP (Honours) Regular Examination March 2026

Fourth Semester

Discipline Specific Course (DSC)- MG4DSCENG201- READING PROSE AND FICTION

(2024 Admission Onwards)

Duration: 2 hrs **Max. Marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation

PART A - MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. b) Logical progression (An) / (CO1)
2. c) Dead continue to guide and comfort the living (U) / (CO2)
3. c) A passive observer through whom emotional tension is revealed (U) / (CO3)
4. c) Ceremonies and songs (K) / (CO4)
5. d) None of these *(Note: He is called "Old Hack")* (K) / (CO4)
6. b) Psaltery (An) / (CO1)
7. d) Different origins, beliefs, and destinies (U) / (CO2)
8. d) The Irish revolutionary movement (U) / (CO3)
9. b) Anthropocene (K) / (CO4)
10. b) The ice would melt and drown the Valley (U) / (CO4)

(1x10=10)

PART B - SHORT ANSWERS

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. A smile reflects the interior state of the soul, not just social politeness
Genuine smiles come from inner warmth; forced ones betray inner coldness
Smiles add little to self-expression if we are dull, sinister, or smug, they merely mirror the inner self. (An) / (CO1)

12. Collecting begins as pleasure/completion of a set
- Repetition reveals the collector is trapped in obsessive logic
- Each duplicate undermines the uniqueness that gave collecting meaning
- The collection starts to possess the collector rather than vice versa (An) / (CO2)

13. The domestic space in Sweetness (Toni Morrison) is not neutral; it replicates class/power structures
- Characters within the family occupy positions analogous to social rank
- Sweetness exposes how oppression is reproduced at home
- The personal becomes a microcosm of the political (U) / (CO3)

14. Colleague of ER Braithwaite in To Sir With Love.
- Referred to as kind and intelligent.
- Joins him on the class museum trip, friendship turns to affection.
- While on a dinner with her, Braithwaite is racially insulted by restaurant sttaff.
- His calmness impresses her and their bond strengthens through shared understanding.

(U) / (CO4)

15. Treats students as young adults deserving respect, not problem children
- Establishes mutual respect as the foundation of the classroom
- Moves away from rote learning toward personal responsibility
- Uses real-life relevance to engage disaffected East End students
- Insists on formal address (Mr/Miss) to instil dignity. (U) / (CO4)

16. The mind, like a sea anemone, sends out tentacles to feel and absorb the world
- Reading/consciousness is an act of reaching out and pulling experience inward
- Suggests the self is porous, not fixed — constantly shaped by what it touches
- Used to describe the reading experience as organic, not purely rational (An) / (CO1)

17. Narrator's extreme nervousness makes him appear suspicious

- He asks to speak privately, making the manager think something serious is afoot
- Narrator's small deposit contrasts absurdly with the gravity of the private meeting
- Each attempt to clarify worsens the confusion
- Comic escalation driven by mutual misreading of social cues (U) / (CO2)

18. Remains composed and emotionally controlled on the surface

- Internally registers the tension but chooses not to escalate
- Uses silence and presence rather than direct intervention
- Her reaction reveals the emotional labour of keeping domestic peace (U) / (CO3)

19. "Sir" marks formal respect crossing class and racial lines

- "With Love" signals affection beyond institutional duty
- The phrase captures the transformation from hostility to genuine regard
- Summarises Braithwaite's method: earn respect, receive love
- The title is the students' tribute. (U) / (CO4)

(5x6=30)

PART C - ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Braithwaite enters a school the system has written off; his mission is implicitly social

- Students are from deprived East End backgrounds; classroom = intervention space
- He addresses racism, poverty, and lack of aspiration directly
- Insists on dignity (formal address, hygiene, conduct) as tools of social uplift
- Builds relationships across racial difference — himself a Black professional in white working-class space
- Teaching becomes consciousness-raising: students learn self-worth alongside curriculum
- His role blurs teacher/mentor/social worker/role model
- The ending (students' gift, Gillian's acceptance) confirms the social bond formed

(An) / (CO4)

21. "Elia" is a pseudonym taken from a real colleague but used as a fictional alter ego

- Allows Lamb to write autobiographically while maintaining ironic distance
- Personal memories (grandmother Field, his brother) appear but filtered through Elia's voice
- The persona enables sentiment without sentimentality — emotion is managed through art
- Elia is both Lamb and not-Lamb: same memories, heightened literary sensibility
- Creates a layered narrator: reader knows the 'truth' behind the fiction
- The essays become a form of self-portraiture through indirection (An) / (CO1)

22. Kaunda's resistance to racial humiliation is rooted in personal dignity, not just ideology

- Refuses to internalise colonial definitions of inferiority
- Self-respect becomes a political stance: to remain dignified is to resist
- Evident in his encounters at the Chemist's shop and restaurant
- Personal experience of discrimination directly fuels his political vision; founded UNIP (United National Independence Party)
- Dignity is framed as both a human right and a political foundation (An) / (CO2)

23. The narrator is a stranger to whom the disfigured man (the Moon) tells his story

- Creates dramatic irony: reader senses the narrator may be complicit
- The twist — narrator IS the coward he has been condemning — depends on first-person concealment
- First person allows the story to be a confession disguised as an accusation
- Reader is manipulated alongside the narrator-listener
- Borges uses the technique to question how identity and guilt are narrated
- The shape of the scar becomes the shape of the story (An) / (CO3)

(15x2=30)